

Robert Walters

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Re : Head of Corporate Accounting

This role sits at the intersection of BGAAP, IFRS, and a mandate to modernize processes through technology, inside an insurance company running its financial operations from Brussels. That combination of regulatory depth and operational redesign is exactly where I've spent the last two decades.

At Coface, I built the Data Warehouse for investments (field definitions, table structure, input and output controls) and rolled out IFRS 9 in stages over four years: successive POCs, ECL methodology, accounting entries, testing, and coordination with the depositary CACEIS. At CNP, I automated the projected financial production across asset classes (P&L, cash flows) and the Solvency II investment reporting on €350bn in assets, taking SimCorp Dimension from design to go-live in 18 months. Both mandates required the same discipline this role calls for: closing accuracy, clear ownership across teams, and technical accounting judgment that holds up under audit and regulatory scrutiny. I've also managed teams directly throughout, from 16 collaborators in a technical accounting function at Coface to project teams of 10 to 15 people, so leading a team of 5 across general ledger, AP/AR, and fixed assets fits naturally into how I work.

Robert Walters places this position with a company that clearly wants someone who can run the closing process and improve it at the same time, not just maintain it. That dual mandate is the part I find most interesting.

I operate as an independent consultant today. Nevertheless, I am perfectly open to a permanent role, directly or after an initial engagement period. On the hybrid setup: it's a normal way of working for me, and my most recent mandate at Clearwater, running several parallel SaaS implementations with monthly senior sponsor committees, was delivered entirely with distributed teams and remote governance tools.

I would be happy to discuss how this experience applies to the closing and reporting priorities you've outlined.

Best regards,

Xavier Robitaille